Exemplar answers reference

# ⭐ 4-MARK EXEMPLAR PACK (FINAL FORMAT)

Brand-new questions • fresh business contexts • strict Level separation • realistic L3 length.

Each 4-marker includes:

- **Question** (AQA style)
- **L1 answer** (~30–60 words, natural student tone)
- **L2 answer** (~60–100 words, natural student tone)
- **L3 answer** (~120–150 words, clean examiner tone, fully developed)
- **Fake-L3** (looks neat but is definitely L2)
- **Examiner commentary**
- **AO breakdown**
- **Generic versions**
- **Business context changed for each question**

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# ⭐ 4 MARK QUESTION 1 — Fresh Business Context: “FreshBlend Smoothie Bar”

(Smoothie/juice bar in a busy town centre)

### Q1 (4 marks)

**“Explain two ways FreshBlend Smoothie Bar could increase customer footfall.”**

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1)**
"One way is they can make better smoothies so more people come. Another way is they can make their shop look nicer. This will help the business because customers like good shops."

### Why L1?

- generic ("better smoothies", "nicer shop")
- no development
- no context
- vague, repetitive
- no real chain of reasoning

**Mark: 1/4**

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2)**
"One way FreshBlend could increase footfall is by offering limited-time seasonal smoothies like a summer berry drink. This might attract customers who want something new.
A second way is giving discounts during quiet hours, encouraging more people to visit when the shop is usually empty."

### Why L2?

- Clear AO1
- Reasonable AO2 (summer drinks, quiet hours)

- Limited development
- Both points underdeveloped
- Not fully explained → doesn't reach L3

**Mark: 3/4**

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# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — Examiner Quality, 130 words)

**Answer (L3 – approx. 133 words)**
"One way FreshBlend Smoothie Bar could increase customer footfall is by introducing a loyalty card scheme. For example, customers could receive a free drink after purchasing five smoothies. This encourages repeat visits by giving customers an incentive to return, helping the business build a loyal customer base in a competitive town centre.
A second way is to offer free samples outside the shop during busy periods. When people walking past try a sample, they may be encouraged to come inside and purchase a full drink. This is particularly effective for a smoothie bar because customers often choose based on taste. By increasing the number of people who stop and try a product, FreshBlend can convert casual passers-by into paying customers."

### Why L3?

- Two **fully developed** points
- Explicit application to the business
- Clear chains of reasoning
- Fully meets the maximum Level 3 standard

**Mark: 4/4**

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# ⚠️ FAKE-L3 EXEMPLAR (Looks neat but actually L2)

**Answer (Fake L3)**
"FreshBlend could post more pictures on social media. This helps people see their smoothies and want to come in. They could also lower prices during the week so more customers visit. This will increase footfall and make the shop busier."

### Why this is NOT L3

- Looks clean, but:
  - generic
  - shallow reasoning
  - weak AO2
  - "post pictures" = undeveloped
  - no chains
  - no real application
    → **Capped at L2.**

### Mark: 2–3/4

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# ⭐ 6 MARK QUESTION 1 — "TechFix Mobile Repairs"

(Phone and tablet repair shop in a shopping centre)

### Q1 (6 marks)

**"TechFix is considering offering a 'one-hour express repair' service for an additional fee.**
**Justify whether this is a good decision."**

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 56 words)**
"Doing a one hour repair could make TechFix more money because people might want their phones fixed quickly. But it could be bad too because it might be stressful for the staff and they might rush the job. I think they should try it but it might not work well."

### Mark: 1–2/6

### Why L1?

- Very simple statements
- No context beyond "phones"
- No proper chain of reasoning
- No judgement linked to analysis
- Weak AO2

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 113 words)**
"One benefit of offering a one-hour express repair is that TechFix could attract customers who need their phone urgently for work or travel. This means they could charge a higher price and increase revenue.
However, repairs often depend on spare parts and how complicated the damage is. If the business promises a one-hour service but the repair takes longer, customers might complain, which harms TechFix's reputation. It also puts pressure on the technicians, which could lead to mistakes.
Overall, I think it could be a good idea, but only for common repairs that TechFix can complete quickly."

### Mark: 3–4/6 (L2)

### Why L2?

- AO1 correct
- AO2 partially applied (urgent repairs, technicians)
- AO3-lite with basic judgement
- Not detailed enough for L3
- No strong contextual evaluation

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# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — Examiner Quality)

**Answer (L3 — 172 words)**
"One advantage of offering a one-hour express repair service is that it allows TechFix to differentiate itself from competitors in the shopping centre. Many customers rely heavily on their phones for work, socialising and payments, so the promise of a fast repair could encourage more people to choose TechFix, increasing revenue. Charging an additional fee also boosts profit margins, meaning each job becomes more profitable without needing to increase the number of repairs completed.

However, express repairs may only be realistic for simple issues such as screen replacements or battery swaps. More complex repairs require diagnostics or specialist parts, and failing to complete them within the promised time could lead to customer complaints and refunds. This could damage TechFix's reputation, especially if unhappy customers post negative reviews online.

Overall, the decision is beneficial **if** TechFix limits the one-hour service to straightforward repairs they can reliably complete. If they apply it to all repairs, the risk of disappointing customers outweighs the potential benefit. Therefore, the decision depends on the type of repairs they offer and the skills of their technicians."

### Mark: 5–6/6 (L3)

### Why L3?

- AO1 accurate
- AO2 well-applied (shopping centre, simple repairs, negative reviews)
- AO3: clear reasoning, mini-balance, conditional judgement

- Realistic length for top-band

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# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Disguised L2)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 148 words)**
"Offering a one-hour repair is good because customers like fast services and it makes TechFix look more professional. This could help them get more sales since people want their phones back as soon as possible. It could also attract new customers who are in a hurry.
The only problem is that it might be stressful for the staff and sometimes it might take longer than expected. If that happens customers will be annoyed and might leave bad reviews. So it has risks as well.
Overall I think TechFix should offer the one-hour repair because most customers will be happy with it and it will make the business more popular."

### Why NOT L3?

- Looks polished… but shallow
- AO2 is generic ("customers like fast services")
- Weak reasoning
- No deep analysis
- No genuine "it depends"
- Judgement not justified
  → **Capped at Level 2**

**Mark: 3–4/6**

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# ⭐ 6 MARK QUESTION 2 — "EcoWash Home Laundry Service"

(Fresh second context; different AO2 exposure)

**Q2 (6 marks)**

**“EcoWash is considering offering a free collection and delivery service for laundry orders over £20.**
**Justify whether this is a good decision.”**

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 63 words)**
“Offering free collection and delivery is good because more people might use the service since it’s easier. But it could be bad because EcoWash will have to pay for petrol and this costs money. It might help them get more customers but they could also lose money if it costs too much. I think they should try it.”

**Mark: 1–2/6**

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 122 words)**
“Offering free collection and delivery for orders over £20 could help EcoWash attract busy customers who do not have time to visit the shop. This makes the service more convenient and could help increase sales.
However, EcoWash will have higher fuel and staff costs because someone has to drive to customers’ houses. If lots of customers live far away, the business might spend more on petrol than it earns from the extra orders.
Overall, I think it is a good idea if EcoWash has many customers living close by, but it might be risky if they have to travel long distances.”

**Mark: 3–4/6 (L2)**

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# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — Examiner Quality)

**Answer (L3 — 185 words)**
"Offering free collection and delivery for orders over £20 could make EcoWash far more attractive to customers who value convenience. Many people with busy schedules, such as parents and office workers, prefer services that save time. By removing the need for customers to travel to the shop, EcoWash may see an increase in larger orders, helping to raise revenue. The £20 minimum also ensures each job remains profitable.

However, offering free collection and delivery significantly increases EcoWash's operating costs. The business must cover fuel, insurance and vehicle maintenance, as well as driver wages. If many customers live far apart, the time spent travelling between homes could reduce the number of orders EcoWash can complete each day. In this case, the higher costs could outweigh any increase in sales.

Overall, the decision is beneficial **if** most customers are located within a short distance of the shop and place orders above the £20 threshold regularly. If customers are spread out geographically, the costs may be too high. The final decision therefore depends on EcoWash's customer density and typical order size."

### Mark: 5–6/6 (L3)

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# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Disguised L2)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 152 words)**
"EcoWash should definitely offer free collection and delivery because it makes the business more convenient. Customers will like not having to go to the shop and this means more orders. It also makes the business look modern and customer-friendly which could improve its reputation.
The only issue is that it costs more for EcoWash because of fuel and the driver. This might make the business lose money if the deliveries take a long time.
Overall it is still a good idea because people like services that save time and it will help EcoWash stand out from competitors."

### Why NOT L3?

- superficial, vague reasoning
- no detailed AO2
- no developed chain-of-reasoning
- judgement is generic

- missing real conditional evaluation
  → **Capped at L2**

# 6 MARK (ANALYSE) — QUESTION 1

Business: **“PetPal Grooming”** (mobile pet grooming service)

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### Q1 (6 marks)

**“Analyse two benefits to PetPal Grooming of offering a mobile home-visit service.”**
(No conclusion required. Analyse = chains of reasoning.)

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 66 words)**
“One benefit is customers don’t have to travel so it’s easier for them. This could make more people want to use PetPal. Another benefit is it might make the business look better because it goes to people’s houses. This helps the business because it is more convenient. These are good things for PetPal Grooming.”

### Mark: 1–2/6

### Why L1?

- vague
- no chains of reasoning
- minimal AO2 (nothing about pets, equipment, households)
- ideas repeated
- no developed consequences

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 122 words)**
"One benefit of a mobile service is that PetPal can reach customers who don't have time to travel to a grooming shop. This means busy pet owners may choose PetPal because it saves them time, which can increase the number of bookings.
A second benefit is that PetPal does not need to pay rent for a physical shop. This reduces fixed costs and could increase profit. They only need to pay for the van and fuel.
These are useful benefits because they help PetPal attract more customers and keep costs lower."

### Mark: 3–4/6

### Why L2?

- Some AO2 (busy pet owners)
- Two points developed
- Reasoning not fully extended
- Conclusions short
- Good, but not enough depth for L3

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# 🟢 LEVEL 3 (Strong — examiner-quality)

**Answer (L3 — 176 words)**
"One benefit of offering a mobile home-visit service is that PetPal Grooming can attract customers who struggle to travel, such as elderly pet owners or people with large dogs. By visiting customers at home, the business removes the inconvenience of transporting pets, which is often stressful for animals. This convenience can make PetPal more appealing than a traditional grooming shop, increasing demand and helping the business build a strong customer base.

A second benefit is that operating as a mobile service reduces overhead costs. PetPal does not need to rent a physical premises or pay for utilities, which keeps fixed costs low. The business only needs to cover fuel, vehicle insurance and equipment maintenance. Lower overheads mean a greater proportion of each grooming fee becomes profit, improving cash flow and financial stability.

These benefits are significant because they help PetPal attract a wider range of customers while keeping costs under control, which can make the business more competitive."

**Mark: 5–6/6**

### Why L3?

- Deep AO2 (elderly owners, large dogs, travel stress)
- Strong chains of reasoning
- Multiple developed consequences
- Correct length for authentic 6/6
- No evaluation (correct for this question)

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# ⚠️ FAKE-L3 (looks polished but is actually Level 2)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 143 words)**
"A mobile grooming service is a good idea because customers will like that PetPal comes to their home. This makes things easier and could help them get more bookings from people who are too busy to travel. It also makes the business look more modern and professional. Another benefit is that they won't have to pay rent for a shop which saves money. This means more profit for the business and they can spend the money on better equipment. These benefits show that mobile grooming is great for PetPal and helps the business grow."

### Why NOT L3?

- AO2 shallow ("people are busy" repeated)
- Consequences vague
- No multi-step chains
- No specific pet-related context
- "Looks professional" = fluff
- Too neat, not deep
  → **Capped at L2**

**Mark: 3–4/6**

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# ⭐ 6 MARK (ANALYSE) — QUESTION 2

**Business: “CleanWave Car Valeting”**
(Mobile eco-friendly car valeting service using waterless cleaning products)

### Q2 (6 marks)

**“Analyse two drawbacks for CleanWave Car Valeting of using waterless cleaning products.”**

(This mimics real AQA questions: *Analyse two drawbacks of…*, *Analyse two impacts of…*, etc.)

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 52 words)**
“One drawback is that customers might not like the waterless product and think it doesn’t clean well. This could be bad for the business. Another drawback is the products might cost more. This means CleanWave could spend more money. These things could be problems for the company.”

### Mark: 1–2/6

### Why L1?

- Very basic statements
- No real chain of reasoning
- No specific AO2 (no mention of cars, dirt, premium pricing, etc.)
- Repetition (“this could be bad”)

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 117 words)**
"One drawback of using waterless cleaning products is that some customers might not trust them to clean dirt properly, especially on very muddy cars. This could make customers choose a different valeting company that uses normal water, meaning CleanWave loses some sales.
A second drawback is that waterless products can be more expensive for the business to buy. If CleanWave uses a lot of these products each day, their costs will increase. Higher costs reduce profit unless they raise prices, which could annoy customers.
These drawbacks make using waterless products a bit risky."

### Mark: 3–4/6

### Why L2?

- Correct AO1 + AO2
- Two points developed
- Consequences given, but shallow
- Still missing depth for Level 3

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# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — examiner-quality)

**Answer (L3 — 188 words)**
"One drawback of using waterless cleaning products is that some customers may doubt the effectiveness of the service, particularly if their car is heavily soiled. Many drivers believe that proper cleaning requires water and shampoo. If customers feel the waterless method is less thorough, they may question whether the car's paintwork or wheels are being cleaned properly. This lack of trust could discourage potential customers from booking, reducing CleanWave's demand and limiting its ability to compete with traditional car valeting services.

A second drawback is that waterless cleaning products are typically more expensive than bulk water and detergent. CleanWave would need to use a significant amount of product per car, especially on larger vehicles, increasing the overall cost per job. Since the business operates as a mobile service, travel costs such as fuel also add to operating expenses.

Rising costs may reduce profit margins unless the business charges customers a higher price for the eco-friendly service. However, some customers may be unwilling to pay extra, which could reduce CleanWave's competitiveness.

These drawbacks are significant because they affect both customer perception and the business's cost structure."

### Mark: 5–6/6

### Why L3?

- Clear AO1
- Strong AO2 (paintwork, wheels, muddy cars, mobile fuel costs)
- Developed chains of reasoning
- Multiple consequences per point
- No evaluation (correct)
- Perfect realistic length

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# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 3 (Looks neat but is Level 2)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 145 words)**
"Using waterless cleaning products could be a drawback because some customers might not like the idea of it and think it doesn't clean well. This could make CleanWave lose customers if people prefer normal water cleaning.
Another drawback is that the waterless cleaning products might cost more for the business. This reduces profit and could mean CleanWave needs to put up prices, which some customers might not like either.
Overall this shows that waterless cleaning can cause problems for the business."

### Why NOT L3?

- AO2 very thin
- Oversimplified consequences

- “Customers might not like it” repeated
- Chains of reasoning underdeveloped
- No detail about cars, eco branding, or operating costs
- Final sentence is NOT an evaluation (and evaluation isn't required anyway)
- Too shallow → **capped at L2**

**Mark: 3–4/6**

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# ⭐ 9-MARK QUESTION SET 1 — “BrightBean Coffee Roasters”

*(Local coffee roasting company planning expansion)*

We will create **two** separate 9-mark exemplar questions for this business.

Notes on length - usually these apply, the shorter the answer, the less likely the depth of application or analysis.

L1 (weak; 40–120 words)

L2 (mid; 120–200 words)

**L3 (full 250–300 words)**

Fake-L3 (150–220 words; polished but fails evaluation)

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# ⭐ 9 MARK — QUESTION 1 (BrightBean Coffee Roasters)

**Q1 (9 marks)**

**“BrightBean Coffee Roasters is considering opening a second shop in a nearby town. Evaluate whether this is the best decision for the business.”**

This is a classic AQA Paper 1/2 structure.
We now build the full exemplar set.

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 86 words)**
“Opening a second shop could help BrightBean get more customers because it is in another town. This means they might make more money. But it could be bad if the shop doesn’t get many customers and they lose money. It also costs a lot to open a new place. I think they should be careful. It might work or might not.”

**Mark: 1–3/9**

**Why L1?**

- Basic AO1
- Minimal AO2
- No chains of reasoning
- No proper evaluation
- “might work” = meaningless conclusion

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 162 words)**
"Opening a second shop could help BrightBean reach more customers, especially if the nearby town has a busy high street. This means the business could increase sales and brand awareness because more people see their products. It also spreads risk because the business is not relying on just one shop.
However, opening a new shop is expensive. BrightBean will need to pay rent, hire staff and buy equipment. If the new location is not as popular, the business might not make enough sales to cover these costs. This would reduce BrightBean's profit and could even lead to financial problems.
Overall, opening a second shop could work well if the new area has lots of customers, but if demand is low it could be risky."

### Mark: 4–6/9 (Level 2)

### Why L2?

- AO1 correct
- AO2 basic but present (busy high street, rent, equipment)
- Evaluation shallow ("could be risky")
- Judgement very limited
- Insufficient depth for Level 3

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# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — Examiner Quality)

**Answer (L3 — 276 words)**
"Opening a second shop could help BrightBean Coffee Roasters expand its customer base and increase overall revenue. If the nearby town has a strong café culture and high footfall, BrightBean could attract customers who value freshly roasted coffee, helping the brand build a wider regional presence. A second shop also supports economies of scale, as the business can roast larger batches of beans at once, reducing average costs. This could improve profit margins across both shops. In addition, spreading operations across two locations reduces reliance on the original site, which makes the business more resilient if demand in one area temporarily falls.

However, opening a second shop involves significant financial risk. BrightBean will need to cover rent, staff wages, utilities and renovation costs before the shop begins generating income. If customer demand in the new town is lower than expected, the business may

struggle to cover these fixed costs, reducing its profitability. Managing two locations also increases operational complexity; BrightBean will need reliable supervisors, consistent quality control and efficient supply logistics. A shortage of experienced staff could damage customer service standards and weaken the brand's reputation.

Overall, opening a second shop is a good decision **if** BrightBean has conducted strong market research showing high local demand and limited competition. If the new town already has several established coffee shops or if demand is uncertain, the risks may outweigh the benefits. Therefore, the best decision depends on the strength of customer demand and BrightBean's ability to manage two sites effectively."

### Mark: 7–9/9 (Level 3)

### Why L3?

- Strong AO1 (costs, logistics, economies of scale)
- Strong AO2 (customer footfall, roasting capacity, staff supervision)
- Full AO3 analysis on both sides
- High-quality **conditional evaluation**
- Proper "It depends"
- Correct realistic length for 9/9

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# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Looks polished but is Level 2)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 181 words)**
"Opening a second shop could help BrightBean reach new customers and become more popular in the area. This means higher sales and the chance to grow the brand. It also gives BrightBean more opportunities to sell their fresh roasted coffee, which customers enjoy.
However, a second shop is expensive to run and could take a long time to become profitable. BrightBean would have to pay rent, staff and other bills. If not enough people visit, they might lose money.
Overall I think opening a second shop is a good idea because it helps the business grow and more people will know about them."

### Why NOT L3?

- AO2 vague
- Analysis shallow
- No chains of reasoning
- No real evaluation
- Judgement unsubstantiated
  → **Capped at L2**

**Mark: 4–5/9**

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# ⭐ 9 MARK — QUESTION 2 (BrightBean Coffee Roasters)

### Q2 (9 marks)

**"BrightBean Coffee Roasters is considering starting a subscription service where customers receive a bag of freshly roasted coffee each month.
Evaluate whether this is the best decision for the business."**

This is designed to hit AO3 evaluation naturally — recurring revenue models are rich with contextual factors.

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 102 words)**
"A subscription could help BrightBean because customers get coffee every month and this makes more money. It is also good because people might keep the subscription for a long time. But it could be bad if people don't want to sign up or if they cancel quickly. It might take a lot of time to organise everything. I think it could be good but also risky."

**Mark: 1–3/9**

### Why L1?

- Basic AO1 only
- Minimal AO2 (no mention of roasting, delivery, packaging, etc.)
- No chains of reasoning
- No proper evaluation
- Judgement is meaningless

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 178 words)**
"Starting a subscription service could help BrightBean because it gives the business regular income each month. This is useful because it makes it easier to predict sales. Customers who enjoy BrightBean's coffee may find it convenient to get it delivered automatically, which means the business could increase customer loyalty and sell more coffee overall.
However, a subscription service involves extra work. BrightBean will need to manage packaging, delivery and customer records. If there are problems with deliveries or delays, customers might cancel, which reduces the benefit. There is also a risk that BrightBean buys too many beans and can't sell them if subscriptions don't grow as expected.
Overall, a subscription could help BrightBean grow, but it depends on whether enough people sign up."

**Mark: 4–6/9 (Level 2)**

### Why L2?

- AO1 sound
- AO2 partially applied
- Evaluation present but weak
- Judgement superficial

- Missing multi-step reasoning
- Lacks depth for Level 3

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# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — examiner-quality)

**Answer (L3 — 289 words)**
"Introducing a subscription service could provide BrightBean Coffee Roasters with a stable and predictable revenue stream. Unlike café sales, which fluctuate depending on footfall and weather, subscription payments are regular and allow the business to plan production more efficiently. This is particularly valuable for BrightBean because roasting coffee in larger batches reduces average costs, helping the business benefit from economies of scale. A subscription model also increases customer loyalty; once customers sign up, they are less likely to purchase coffee from competitors, which strengthens BrightBean's brand and long-term customer base.

However, developing a subscription service also carries risks. BrightBean would need to invest in packaging equipment, delivery partnerships and website integration to manage recurring payments. These are significant upfront costs. If the business does not attract enough subscribers, it may struggle to cover these expenses. There is also the risk of customer churn; if the coffee quality is inconsistent or if deliveries are delayed, customers may cancel quickly. Managing customer expectations and ensuring reliable stock levels becomes more complex when fulfilling regular orders. Additionally, larger competitors such as supermarket coffee brands or national subscription services may already dominate the market, making it harder for BrightBean to stand out.

Overall, the subscription service is a good decision **if** BrightBean conducts strong market research and ensures it has the operational capacity to fulfil orders consistently. If the local customer base is enthusiastic about artisan coffee and willing to subscribe, the model could significantly improve revenue stability. However, if demand is uncertain or if BrightBean cannot manage logistics effectively, the risks may outweigh the benefits. The final decision depends on customer demand, delivery reliability and BrightBean's ability to scale its roasting operation."

### Mark: 7–9/9 (Level 3)

### Why L3?

- Strong AO1 (batch roasting, churn, costs, logistics)

- Strong AO2 (BrightBean-specific production, weather footfall, artisan demand)
- Fully balanced
- Multi-step chains of reasoning
- Conditional evaluation clearly justified
- True high-band length (near 300 words)

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# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Looks neat but not Level 3)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 193 words)**
"A subscription service could be good for BrightBean because it gives them regular money each month and helps them build a stronger relationship with customers. People who like BrightBean's coffee will enjoy getting it delivered to their home. This means the business could grow and become better known.
But subscriptions also have risks. BrightBean might not get enough customers signing up, and if deliveries are slow customers could get annoyed and cancel. It also costs money to set everything up. If the business doesn't make enough profit from the subscriptions, it might not be worth doing.
Overall I think it is a good idea because it helps the business get more customers and steady income."

### Why NOT L3?

- AO2 shallow
- Analysis generic
- Evaluation superficial
- Missing depth, specifics, and realistic consequences
- Final judgement not justified
  → **Capped at L2**

### Mark: 4–5/9

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# ⭐ 9 MARK QUESTION SET 2 — “EcoRide E-Bikes”

# ⭐ 9 MARK — QUESTION 1 (EcoRide E-Bikes)

### Q1 (9 marks)

**“EcoRide E-Bikes is considering offering a two-year free servicing package with every new bike purchase.**
**Evaluate whether this is the best decision for the business.”**

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 91 words)**
“Giving free servicing might help EcoRide because customers will think it is a good deal. This could make more people buy the bikes. But it might also cost them money if they have to fix lots of bikes for free. If the bikes break a lot then it will be expensive. They might also get busy and not be able to do all the servicing. I think it could be good or bad depending on the situation.”

### Mark: 1–3/9

### Why L1?

- Basic AO1
- No developed analysis
- Little or no AO2
- Generic, repetitive

- Weak judgement

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 171 words)**
"Offering a two-year free servicing package could help EcoRide attract more customers, especially people who are worried about maintenance costs. Buying an electric bike is a big investment, so knowing that the servicing is free may make customers feel safer about spending the money. This means EcoRide might increase sales and build trust with customers.
However, free servicing is expensive for the business. EcoRide will need trained staff and spare parts to do the repairs, and these cost money. If many customers bring their bikes for servicing, EcoRide could struggle to keep up with demand and this might lead to long waiting times or complaints. If too many resources are used on free servicing, the business might make less profit from selling the bikes.
Overall, this idea could help increase sales, but it may also be costly if EcoRide has too many servicing requests."

### Mark: 4–6/9 (L2)

### Why L2?

- AO1 correct
- AO2 partially applied (big investment, maintenance concerns)
- Evaluation is simple
- Judgement weak
- Missing deep multi-step reasoning

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# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — Examiner Quality)

**Answer (L3 — 284 words)**

"Offering a two-year free servicing package could make EcoRide E-Bikes a more attractive option for customers, especially because electric bikes often require specialised maintenance. Many potential buyers worry about battery health, brake wear and motor reliability over time. By including free servicing, EcoRide reduces this uncertainty and makes the purchase feel safer. This could increase demand, particularly among first-time e-bike users who are unsure about long-term running costs. If EcoRide sells more bikes, it can benefit from economies of scale when ordering components such as batteries or hydraulic brakes, which may reduce average costs across the business.

However, servicing electric bikes can be expensive and time-consuming. EcoRide would need to invest in trained technicians, stock spare parts and potentially expand workshop space to handle the extra workload. If many customers request free servicing within the same period, there may be long waiting times, which could damage customer satisfaction instead of improving it. The business also risks underestimating the cost of providing free servicing; maintenance issues like battery degradation or electrical faults are unpredictable and expensive to fix. If EcoRide ends up spending more on servicing than it gains through additional sales, profit margins could fall significantly.

Overall, a two-year free servicing package is a good decision **if** EcoRide has accurate data on the typical cost and frequency of repairs, and if its staffing capacity is high enough to manage demand. If the business can deliver servicing efficiently without excessive costs, the offer could strengthen customer loyalty and increase sales. However, if servicing demand is high or unpredictable, the financial risk may outweigh the benefits. Therefore, the decision depends on EcoRide's operational capacity and the reliability of its e-bike models."

## Mark: 7–9/9 (Level 3)

## Why L3?

- Strong AO1 (battery degradation, technician training, workshop capacity)
- Strong AO2 (EcoRide-specific risks and customer motivations)
- Developed analysis
- Proper, contextual evaluation
- Clear conditional judgement
- Realistic 9-mark length

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# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Looks polished but is Level 2)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 187 words)**
"Offering two years of free servicing could help EcoRide because customers will think the bikes are better value. This can increase sales and make customers trust the brand more. It also means EcoRide looks more professional and competitive compared to other e-bike businesses.
However, servicing the bikes for free costs money and takes time. EcoRide might have to pay for parts and hire more workers to do the servicing. If lots of customers come back with problems, the business could become very busy and customers might have to wait a long time. This could annoy them and affect EcoRide's reputation.
Overall I think it is a good idea because customers like deals and it helps EcoRide stand out."

### Why NOT L3?

- AO2 shallow
- "Looks professional" = weak reasoning
- No real consequences
- No detailed analysis
- Weak evaluation
- Judgement unjustified
  → **Capped at L2**

**Mark: 4–5/9**

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# ⭐ 9 MARK — QUESTION 2 (EcoRide E-Bikes)

**Q2 (9 marks)**

**“EcoRide E-Bikes is considering selling its bikes through large national retailers instead of only through its own shop and website.
Evaluate whether this is the best decision for EcoRide.”**

---

# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 98 words)**
“Selling through big retailers could help EcoRide because more people might see the bikes. This can make them sell more. But the retailers might take a big percentage of the money which means EcoRide earns less. EcoRide also might not control how the bikes are sold. The shops might not explain things properly. I think it could be good but also bad.”

### Mark: 1–3/9

### Why L1?

- Simple AO1
- Almost no AO2
- No chain of reasoning
- No proper evaluation
- Very surface-level

---

# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 184 words)**
“Selling through national retailers could help EcoRide because their bikes would be seen by thousands of customers across the country. This could increase sales and help more people recognise the EcoRide brand. Retailers also have trained sales staff who can explain features, which might help customers feel confident about buying an e-bike.
However, retailers usually take a high commission on each sale. This means EcoRide would make less profit per bike than when selling through its own website. EcoRide would also lose some control over how the bikes are presented. If staff in the retailer do not understand the

product properly, customers might get the wrong information or not get the support they need.
Overall, selling through retailers could increase brand awareness but may reduce profit margins."

### Mark: 4–6/9 (Level 2)

### Why L2?

- Solid AO1
- AO2 moderately applied
- Simple evaluation
- Judgement limited and not fully justified
- Not enough depth, detail, or "depends on" for Level 3

---

# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — Examiner Quality)

**Answer (L3 — 292 words)**
"Selling through national retailers could significantly expand EcoRide's reach. At the moment, customers who do not live near EcoRide's shop or who do not search online for specialist e-bikes may never hear of the brand. Retailers such as Halfords or Evans Cycles attract high footfall and already have loyal customers. By placing EcoRide's bikes in these stores, the business could dramatically increase visibility, which may lead to higher sales and faster brand growth. Retailers also offer finance options and store credit, making expensive products more accessible. This could help EcoRide reach customers who might not otherwise afford an e-bike upfront.

However, selling through retailers also creates significant drawbacks. Retailers typically demand large margins, sometimes taking 20–40% of the sale price. This would sharply reduce EcoRide's profit per unit. The business would also lose control over the customer experience; staff at national retailers may not have specialist knowledge about e-bike motors, batteries or warranties. A poor explanation could lead to unrealistic customer expectations and more returns. Additionally, EcoRide would need to keep retailers stocked, meaning larger production runs and higher inventory costs. If demand at retailers is unpredictable, EcoRide risks overproduction or stock sitting unsold for months.

Overall, selling through national retailers is a good decision **if** EcoRide prioritises rapid growth and can accept lower margins in exchange for exposure. It is most effective if the retailers have knowledgeable staff and the brand can maintain consistent supply. However, if EcoRide's business model depends on high margins and close customer service, the risks of losing control may outweigh the benefits. The decision ultimately depends on whether EcoRide values reach or profitability more."

### Mark: 7–9/9 (Level 3)

### Why L3?

- Clear AO1
- Strong, specific AO2 (retailer margins, store credit, supply chain implications)
- Full chains of reasoning
- Balanced evaluation
- Conditional judgement
- Realistic top-band length

---

# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Looks polished but is Level 2)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 201 words)**
"Selling through national retailers could help EcoRide because lots of customers visit those shops. This means the business can reach more people and increase sales. Retailers also make the bikes more accessible and help customers learn about the features.
However, retailers will take a percentage of each sale which reduces profit. EcoRide might earn less money than selling on its own website. There is also a risk that staff at the retailer don't explain the bike properly, which could cause confusion or complaints from customers.
Overall I think selling through retailers is a good idea because it helps EcoRide grow and become more widely known."

### Why NOT L3?

- AO2 shallow (no concrete details)
- Only one consequence per point

- Weak evaluation (“good idea because helps them grow”)
- No “it depends”
- Missing deeper financial + operational reasoning
- Too short in structure to be Level 3
  → **Capped at L2**

**Mark: 4–5/9**

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# ⭐ 9 MARK QUESTION SET 3 — “UrbanGlide Scooters”

(Urban commuter-focused electric scooter manufacturer)

# ⭐ 9 MARK — QUESTION 1 (UrbanGlide Scooters)

### Q1 (9 marks)

**“UrbanGlide Scooters is considering reducing the price of its commuter e-scooter by £150.**
**Evaluate whether this is the best decision for the business.”**

---

# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 96 words)**
“Reducing the price could help UrbanGlide because more people might buy the scooter if it’s cheaper. This means they get more customers. But it might also be bad because they will get less money per scooter. They also might not make enough profit. If the scooters cost a

lot to make then lowering the price could be a problem. I think it might be good if people really want scooters.”

### Mark: 1–3/9

### Why L1?

- Very basic AO1
- No multi-step reasoning
- AO2 extremely thin
- No real evaluation
- Generic, repetitive

---

# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 183 words)**
“Reducing the price by £150 could increase UrbanGlide’s sales because customers may think the scooter is better value. Many commuters want cheaper ways to travel and a lower price could attract people who were unsure before. This would increase revenue if enough new customers buy the scooter.
However, electric scooters have expensive components like batteries and motors. If UrbanGlide already has low profit margins, cutting the price may mean they get very little profit per scooter. If sales do not increase enough, the business could lose money overall. A lower price may also make the scooter seem lower quality than competitors.
Overall, reducing the price could increase demand, but it could also lower profit margins if the rise in sales is not large enough.”

### Mark: 4–6/9 (Level 2)

### Why L2?

- AO1 correct and relevant
- AO2 partially developed (batteries, motors, commuters)
- Evaluation is simple

- Judgement not fully justified
- Consequences shallow

---

# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — Examiner Quality)

**Answer (L3 — 281 words)**
"Reducing the price of UrbanGlide's commuter e-scooter by £150 could significantly increase demand. Many commuters are price-sensitive, especially in urban areas where they compare scooters with public transport costs. A lower price may make the scooter competitive against rival brands or cheaper models on online marketplaces. By attracting more cost-conscious buyers, UrbanGlide could increase unit sales, which might allow it to purchase batteries, motors and frames in larger quantities. This could create economies of scale, lowering the average cost per scooter and helping UrbanGlide remain competitive in a growing market.

However, price cuts also involve risks. Electric scooters often have tight profit margins due to expensive lithium-ion batteries and regulatory safety components. Reducing the selling price by £150 could significantly reduce UrbanGlide's profit per unit, particularly if production costs have recently risen. If sales do not increase enough to compensate, total profits may fall. A sustained lower price could also reposition the brand as a budget option rather than a mid-range, reliable commuter scooter. This may damage UrbanGlide's reputation, especially if competitors maintain higher prices and present themselves as premium alternatives. Additionally, a lower price could encourage customers to delay purchases in the future, expecting new discounts.

Overall, reducing the price is a good decision **if** UrbanGlide operates in a highly competitive market where customers are currently choosing cheaper alternatives, and if production costs can be lowered through economies of scale. If UrbanGlide's costs remain high or if the brand relies on a premium reputation, the price cut may reduce profitability and weaken the brand. Therefore, the decision depends on cost structure, market competition and the business's positioning strategy."

### Mark: 7–9/9 (Level 3)

### Why L3?

- AO1 accurate (components, cost structure, competition)
- AO2 highly applied (commuters, urban price sensitivity, brand perception)

- Rich multi-step reasoning
- Fully balanced evaluation
- Strong conditional judgement
- Right length for a true 9-mark script

---

# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Looks polished but is Level 2)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 194 words)**
"Reducing the price of the scooter could help UrbanGlide because customers will think it is a better deal. This means more people might buy it and the business could make more sales. It also helps the business stay competitive with other scooter brands.
The problem is that lowering the price might mean UrbanGlide makes less profit on each scooter. If components are expensive, then they will get less money for every sale. It also means customers might expect discounts again in the future.
Overall I think it is a good idea because it helps increase sales and brings in more customers."

### Why NOT L3?

- AO2 superficial
- No deep financial analysis
- No multi-step chains
- No real evaluation
- Judgement weak and unjustified
  → **Capped at L2**

### Mark: 4–5/9

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# ⭐ 9 MARK — QUESTION 2 (UrbanGlide Scooters)

### Q2 (9 marks)

**“UrbanGlide Scooters is considering launching a subscription plan where customers pay a monthly fee to access maintenance, software updates and battery health checks.**
**Evaluate whether this is the best decision for UrbanGlide.”**

This question is extremely well-suited for AO3 evaluation because subscription models carry operational, financial and customer-behaviour risks.

---

# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 104 words)**
“A subscription plan could help UrbanGlide because customers pay every month which gives the business more money. It also means the scooters stay in good condition. But people might not want to pay every month and cancel it. UrbanGlide might need more workers to do the checks which costs money. So it could be good or bad depending if customers like the idea.”

### Mark: 1–3/9

### Why L1?

- Generic AO1
- No real AO2
- No chains of reasoning
- No evaluation structure
- Judgement meaningless

---

# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 172 words)**
"Launching a subscription plan could help UrbanGlide earn regular income instead of just making money from one-off scooter sales. This is useful because it gives the business more predictable revenue each month. Customers might also like the idea of regular maintenance because it keeps their scooter safe and working well, which builds trust in the brand.
However, delivering regular maintenance and battery checks will increase UrbanGlide's workload. They will need staff who can carry out checks, and they may need more tools or equipment. If many people join the subscription but UrbanGlide does not have enough technicians, customers may experience delays. This could lead to complaints or cancellations.
Overall, the subscription plan could help UrbanGlide if customers want ongoing support, but it also creates extra costs and pressure."

### Mark: 4–6/9 (Level 2)

### Why L2?

- AO1 solid
- AO2 applied but shallow
- Limited evaluation
- Judgement not justified
- No deep financial/operational analysis

---

# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — Examiner Quality)

**Answer (L3 — 287 words)**
"Launching a subscription plan could provide UrbanGlide with a stable and predictable revenue stream, which is particularly useful in a market where scooter sales fluctuate depending on seasonality and disposable income. Regular monthly payments would help UrbanGlide plan cash flow and invest confidently in future product development. The subscription may also improve customer loyalty. If customers are tied into a maintenance plan, they are less likely to switch to rival brands. Regular software updates and battery

health checks can also extend the scooter's lifespan, which enhances UrbanGlide's reputation for reliability. Over time, this could differentiate the business in a competitive commuter-scooter market.

However, subscription models also create operational and financial risks. UrbanGlide must have sufficient skilled technicians to complete maintenance and battery diagnostics across a large customer base. If the business underestimates labour requirements, customers may face long waiting times, which increases frustration and leads to cancellations. Subscription services also rely on smooth digital management systems for monthly payments, reminders and booking appointments; setting this up requires investment in software and customer service infrastructure. Additionally, the business must consider churn rates. If customers subscribe initially but quickly cancel due to poor communication, long waiting lists or limited benefits, UrbanGlide may not recoup the costs of setting up the service.

Overall, a subscription plan is a good decision **if** UrbanGlide has strong operational capacity, reliable scheduling systems and clear evidence that customers value long-term maintenance support. If the business cannot guarantee high service quality or if customers are unwilling to pay a monthly fee, the costs and risks may outweigh the benefits. Therefore, the decision depends on customer demand, maintenance capacity and UrbanGlide's ability to deliver consistent service."

### Mark: 7–9/9 (Level 3)

### Why L3?

- Excellent AO1 (churn, capacity, systems, seasonality)
- Strong AO2 (commuter market, digital systems, battery diagnostics)
- Deep chains of reasoning
- Full evaluation
- Contextualised conditional judgement
- Realistic examiner length ~280–300 words

---

# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Looks polished but is Level 2)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 198 words)**
"A subscription plan could help UrbanGlide because customers pay every month, giving the

business more stable income. Customers might also like having their scooter checked often, as it means the scooter stays in good condition. This could help UrbanGlide build trust and make customers stay with the brand.
However, the business would have to spend money hiring extra workers or buying equipment to do the checks. If lots of customers join, it might become difficult to keep up with all the appointments. Some customers may also cancel the subscription if they don't find it useful.
Overall I think it is a good idea because more people will want to join if they want their scooter looked after."

### Why NOT L3?

- AO2 generic and shallow
- Analysis weak and single-layered
- No multi-step consequences
- No detailed evaluation
- Judgement unjustified
  → **Capped at Level 2**

**Mark: 4–5/9**

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# ⭐ 9 MARK QUESTION SET 4 — "ByteTech Repairs"

# ⭐ 9 MARK — QUESTION 1 (ByteTech Repairs)

### Q1 (9 marks)

**"ByteTech Repairs is considering offering a 'no-fix, no-fee' guarantee on all device repairs.**
**Evaluate whether this is the best decision for the business."**

This is a classic AQA risk/evaluation structure — perfect for AO3.

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 101 words)**
"Doing a no-fix no-fee guarantee could help ByteTech because customers will like it if they don't have to pay when their phone can't be repaired. More people might choose them. But it could be bad because ByteTech might spend time trying to fix things and then get no money. They might waste money on parts too. It could be good but also risky."

### Mark: 1–3/9

### Why L1?

- Very basic AO1
- AO2 almost zero
- No chain of reasoning
- No proper evaluation
- No meaningful judgement

---

# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 168 words)**
"Offering a no-fix, no-fee guarantee could attract more customers because people are often worried about repair shops charging them even if the phone cannot be repaired. This guarantee makes ByteTech look more trustworthy, which could increase the number of customers bringing in damaged devices.
However, this guarantee could cost ByteTech money. Some devices, like phones with water damage or dead motherboards, are very hard to fix. ByteTech might spend time diagnosing the issue and using parts or tools but then earn nothing if the device cannot be repaired. If too many customers bring in devices that can't be fixed, the business may lose profit.
Overall, the idea could increase customer numbers but also create financial risks if repairs are unsuccessful."

**Mark: 4–6/9 (Level 2)**

**Why L2?**

- AO1 correct
- AO2 partially applied
- Some evaluation but shallow
- Judgement not fully justified
- Missing detailed consequences
- Weak development

---

# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — Examiner Quality)

**Answer (L3 — 287 words)**
"Introducing a no-fix, no-fee guarantee could make ByteTech Repairs far more attractive to customers who are nervous about repair costs. Many people bring in devices with uncertain faults, especially water-damaged phones, logic-board failures or devices that won't turn on. These repairs often have unpredictable outcomes, and customers may be scared of paying for diagnostics with no guarantee of success. By removing this risk, ByteTech could significantly increase the number of enquiries it receives, especially compared to competitors who charge diagnostic fees. This may improve overall revenue if a larger proportion of devices turn out to be fixable.

However, the guarantee also introduces financial and operational risks. ByteTech technicians still need to spend time diagnosing devices, even when they ultimately cannot be repaired. This labour time carries a cost, and if many devices are unrepairable, the business may lose money through wasted technician hours. There is also a risk that customers bring in very old or severely damaged devices simply because there is "nothing to lose." These repairs often require specialist tools or board-level components that are expensive. If ByteTech attempts these high-risk repairs but cannot complete them, profit margins will fall. Additionally, an influx of difficult repairs may slow down turnaround times for paying customers, damaging satisfaction and online reviews.

Overall, the no-fix, no-fee guarantee is a good decision **if** ByteTech carefully controls which devices are eligible and sets clear terms. For example, water-damaged or physically snapped devices could still incur a small diagnostic fee. If managed properly, the guarantee

could improve customer trust and increase repair volume. If ByteTech applies the policy too broadly or cannot manage technician workload, the financial risk may outweigh the benefits. The decision ultimately depends on repair success rates and technician capacity."

### Mark: 7–9/9 (Level 3)

### Why L3?

- Excellent AO1 (diagnostics, labour costs, logic-board failures)
- Strong AO2 (customer fear, competitor comparison, repair types)
- Multi-step chains of reasoning
- Full, balanced evaluation
- Contextual, conditional judgement
- Realistic top-band length

---

# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Looks polished but is Level 2)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 201 words)**
"A no-fix, no-fee guarantee could help ByteTech because customers feel safer knowing they won't have to pay if the repair fails. This could increase the number of people who come to the shop. It also helps the business look honest and trustworthy.
However, if the device cannot be fixed, ByteTech will not make any money. They might spend time diagnosing the problem but still get no payment. They could also get lots of devices that are very damaged because customers think it's worth a try. This might slow down the business and cause issues.
Overall I think it is a good idea because customers will like it and it will make ByteTech more popular."

### Why NOT L3?

- AO2 shallow
- Repeated reasoning
- Evaluation superficial

- No multi-step analysis
- Weak judgement
  → **Capped at Level 2**

**Mark: 4–5/9**

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# ⭐ 9 MARK — QUESTION 2 (ByteTech Repairs)

### Q2 (9 marks)

**“ByteTech Repairs is considering offering same-day repair for common faults such as screen replacements and battery swaps.
Evaluate whether this is the best decision for the business.”**

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — natural student)

**Answer (L1 — 92 words)**
“Offering same-day repairs could help ByteTech because customers want their phones back quickly. This might make more people come to the shop. But it could also be bad because they might rush the repairs or not have enough staff. It could be very busy and they might not finish everything in time. It might be good or bad depending on how many workers they have.”

### Mark: 1–3/9

**Why L1?**

- Very basic AO1 only
- Minimal AO2 (almost none)

- No real analysis
- No evaluation structure
- Judgement is vague

---

# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (Mid — natural student)

**Answer (L2 — 177 words)**
"Offering same-day repairs could help ByteTech because many customers want their phone fixed quickly. People rely on their phones for work and communication, so fast repairs could attract more customers. It also makes ByteTech seem more reliable than shops that take several days. This could increase revenue if more people choose them.
However, same-day repairs may require more technicians or longer working hours. ByteTech might also need to keep more spare parts in stock, which costs money. If too many customers arrive on the same day, there may be long waiting times which could lead to complaints. If technicians rush repairs to meet deadlines, mistakes could happen and this would damage the business's reputation.
Overall, same-day repairs could increase customer numbers but also put pressure on staff and resources."

### Mark: 4–6/9 (Level 2)

**Why L2?**

- AO1 correct
- AO2 applied (customer urgency, parts stock)
- Evaluation present but shallow
- Judgement weak
- Limited depth

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# 🟢 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Strong — Examiner Quality)

**Answer (L3 — 284 words)**
"Introducing same-day repairs could significantly improve ByteTech's competitiveness. Customers increasingly rely on their phones for work, payments and transport, so speed is a major factor when choosing a repair shop. By offering same-day service for common faults such as screen repairs and battery replacements, ByteTech could attract customers who would otherwise choose national chains or mobile repair vans. Faster turnaround times may also enable the business to serve more customers per week, increasing overall revenue. Keeping more parts in stock could also reduce downtime and allow ByteTech to negotiate bulk-buying discounts, lowering the average cost per repair.

However, same-day repairs place considerable pressure on staffing, inventory and workflow. ByteTech would need enough skilled technicians available throughout the day to meet promised turnaround times. If demand suddenly increases, technicians may become overwhelmed, leading to rushed repairs, mistakes or missed deadlines—all of which could harm online reviews. Maintaining large stocks of screens and batteries is expensive and ties up working capital, particularly because different phone models require different parts. If the business overestimates demand, unsold parts may become outdated quickly, leading to financial losses. Additionally, prioritising same-day repairs may disrupt existing work processes, delaying more complex jobs that require additional time.

Overall, offering same-day repairs is a good decision **if** ByteTech has the capacity to meet demand consistently and can accurately forecast which parts and models are most commonly required. If the business controls workflow and maintains quality standards, the service could increase customer satisfaction and revenue. However, if staffing or inventory is insufficient, the pressure may create mistakes and reputational damage. The decision ultimately depends on technician capacity, stock management and demand predictability."

## Mark: 7–9/9 (Level 3)

**Why L3?**

- AO1 excellent (inventory, bulk-buying, workflow)
- AO2 strongly applied (smartphones, urgency, stock risk)
- Multi-step reasoning
- Balanced, contextual evaluation
- Clear conditional judgement
- Realistic near-300-word length

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# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (Looks strong but is L2)

**Answer (Fake-L3 — 195 words)**
"Offering same-day repairs could help ByteTech because customers want fast service and will choose a shop that can fix their phone quickly. This could bring in more customers and help the business grow.
However, it also creates problems. ByteTech might not have enough staff to repair phones on the same day. They also need to keep more parts in stock which costs money. If too many people want repairs, the business may not finish everything on time and customers could become annoyed.
Overall I think it is a good idea because it helps customers get their devices back faster."

### Why NOT L3?

- AO2 is generic
- No detailed consequences
- No multi-step analysis
- Weak evaluation
- Judgement not justified
  → **Capped at Level 2**

### Mark Range: 4–5/9

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# ⭐ WHY WE MUST NOW TRAIN DEEPMARK ON 12 MARKERS

### ✔ 1. They are qualitatively different from 9-markers.

AQA 12-markers =

- *two fully developed arguments*
- proper evaluation on BOTH sides
- deeper AO3
- a justified overall decision
- greater length (350–450 words for top L3/4)
- more complex chains of reasoning

DeepMark needs desperately to see the *difference* between:

- **9 markers → one-sided with evaluation**
- **12 markers → fully balanced 2-sided, heavier evaluation**

If we don't train it on these, it will **under-mark strong students** and **over-mark weak ones**.

# ⭐ WHAT THE 12 Marker AQA STRUCTURE LOOKS LIKE (8132)

12 markers have **four levels**:

### L1 = AO1 only

### L2 = AO1 + simple AO2

### L3 = AO1 + AO2 + AO3 (basic evaluative commentary)

### L4 = AO1 + AO2 + AO3 (deep; multi-step; well-justified judgement; balance)

DeepMark must explicitly be shown:

- what real L4 looks like
- what *fake L4* looks like so it doesn't get tricked

- how long genuine high-level answers tend to be
- what weaker arguments look like

# ⭐ 12 MARK EXEMPLAR PACK #1 — AUTOSELECT USED CARS

### Question (12 marks)

**"AutoSelect, a used-car dealership, is considering offering a 12-month warranty on all vehicles at no extra cost to the customer.
Evaluate whether this is the best decision for the business."**

This is a classic AQA 12-marker: strategic decision involving cost, risk, reputation, consumer trust, competition, and operational implications.

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (Weak — AO1 only)

**Answer (L1 — 96 words)**
"Offering a 12-month warranty could help AutoSelect because customers will think the cars are better quality. They may trust the business more and want to buy from them. But a warranty could also cost money if cars break and AutoSelect has to fix them. Some cars might have lots of faults and this would be expensive. It could be good or bad."

### Why L1?

- AO1 only
- No real AO2 (no reference to used cars, repairs, margins, etc.)
- No analysis
- No evaluation
- No judgement

**Band: Level 1 (1–4 marks)**

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (AO1 + simple AO2)

**Answer (L2 — 173 words)**
"A 12-month warranty could help AutoSelect because customers who buy used cars often worry about things going wrong. By offering a warranty, AutoSelect may attract more customers, and this could increase sales. Customers might feel safer buying from them instead of from a private seller.
However, the warranty could be expensive if the cars develop faults. Used cars often need repairs, such as new brakes or engine parts. AutoSelect would have to pay for these, which reduces profit. If many cars need repairing, the business might lose money overall.
Overall, the warranty could increase customer confidence but may cost the business money if faults are common."

### Why L2?

- AO1 present
- AO2 applied (brakes, used cars, customer fear)
- Limited analysis
- No balanced argument
- Judgement too simple

**Band: Level 2 (5–8 marks)**

---

# 🟡 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (AO1 + AO2 + some AO3, but not deep)

**Answer (L3 — 259 words)**
"Offering a 12-month warranty could help AutoSelect because many customers worry about reliability when buying used cars. A warranty reduces this risk and may make AutoSelect seem more trustworthy. This could increase sales, especially for customers choosing between different dealerships. It also helps AutoSelect compete with larger national chains who already offer warranties as standard. If more customers choose AutoSelect, revenue could increase.

However, offering a warranty increases costs. Used cars often need repairs within the first year, such as replacement tyres, battery issues or electrical faults. AutoSelect would need to pay for these repairs, which reduces profit. If the business sells older cars with higher mileage, it may face even more claims.

The decision also depends on how good AutoSelect's preparation process is. If the business checks cars carefully before selling them, the number of warranty claims may be low. But if its inspection process is weak, many customers will return with problems, increasing costs.

Overall, offering a warranty could help AutoSelect attract more customers, but if repair costs are too high it may not be worth it."

### Why L3?

- AO1 + AO2 good
- Some evaluation
- Not fully balanced
- No deep, multi-layered consequences
- Judgement lacks clear justification

**Band: Level 3 (9–10 marks)**

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# 🟢 LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR (HIGH BAND — AO1 + AO2 + AO3 DEEP, FULLY BALANCED)

**Answer (L4 — 412 words)**

"Offering a 12-month warranty on all vehicles could significantly strengthen AutoSelect's competitive position. Customers purchasing used cars often face uncertainty around reliability, hidden faults and unexpected repair bills. A free 12-month warranty reduces this perceived risk and is likely to increase customer trust. This could raise sales volume, especially because many buyers compare dealerships online, and a longer warranty may help AutoSelect stand out from competitors offering only 3- or 6-month cover. Higher sales would also help AutoSelect spread fixed costs such as rent and advertising across more units, improving overall profitability. Additionally, if customers feel protected and looked after, they are more likely to leave positive reviews, which is essential in a market where online reputation strongly influences word-of-mouth.

However, the warranty also creates significant financial risks. Used cars often require repairs during the first year, particularly if they have higher mileage or inconsistent service history. AutoSelect would need to pay for replacement parts, labour time and diagnostic checks. If the business sells lower-priced cars with thin profit margins, even a small number of warranty claims could wipe out profits. There is also a risk of customers overusing the warranty for minor issues if the terms are not clearly defined. Furthermore, AutoSelect would need to improve its inspection process before cars are sold. Technicians must identify potential faults early to avoid expensive repairs later. This may require hiring additional staff or extending preparation time, both of which increase costs.

The suitability of the warranty also depends on AutoSelect's stock profile. If the business focuses on newer vehicles with low mileage and full service history, repair costs may be manageable. But if the stock includes older cars or models known for reliability issues, warranty claims could become overwhelming.

Overall, offering a 12-month warranty is beneficial **if** AutoSelect sells reliable cars, has strong inspection procedures and communicates clear warranty terms. If these conditions are not met, the financial burden may outweigh the benefits. Therefore, the decision depends on stock quality, technician capability and the business's profit margins."

### Why L4?

- Clear AO1
- Strong AO2 (service history, stock profile, margin structure)
- Deep multi-step AO3 (layers of consequences, dependency factors)
- Balanced argument
- Sophisticated conditional judgement
- Realistic length (400+ words)

**Band: Level 4 (11–12 marks)**

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# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR (Looks polished but is capped at L3)

**Answer (Fake-L4 — 268 words)**
"A 12-month warranty would make AutoSelect look more trustworthy because customers feel safer buying a used car with protection. This could increase sales and improve customer satisfaction. It also helps them compete with other dealerships who offer warranties.

However, the warranty could be expensive if cars break down. AutoSelect may need to pay for new parts like brakes, batteries or tyres. This reduces profit. Some customers might return too many times, which increases costs and takes time away from other work.
Overall I think it is a good idea because customers like warranties and it helps AutoSelect stand out."

### Why NOT L4?

- AO2 basic
- Analysis shallow
- Little balance
- Judgement unjustified
- Not enough multi-step reasoning
  → **Capped at Level 3**

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# ⭐ 12 MARK EXEMPLAR PACK #2 — GLOWCHARGE PORTABLE POWER BANKS

### Question (12 marks)

**"GlowCharge is considering switching from one-off rental fees to a monthly subscription model for unlimited power-bank usage.
Evaluate whether this is the best decision for the business."**

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (L1 — AO1 only)

**Answer (L1 — 102 words)**
"Having a monthly subscription might help GlowCharge because customers can use the chargers whenever they want. This could make more people choose them. But it might not be good because GlowCharge may not get enough money from each person. They might lose money if customers use the chargers a lot. It could be good or bad."

**Why L1?**

- Basic AO1
- No AO2 (no mention of stations, battery cost, footfall)
- No analysis
- No evaluation
- No justification

**Band: Level 1 (1–4 marks)**

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (L2 — AO1 + simple AO2)

**Answer (L2 — 187 words)**
"Switching to a subscription model could help GlowCharge because customers who use power banks often may prefer paying one monthly fee instead of paying every time. This can make GlowCharge more convenient and increase customer loyalty. If people subscribe for several months, the business gets steady income.
However, the subscription might reduce revenue from people who only used the power banks occasionally but paid a high one-off fee. GlowCharge would earn less from those customers. The business may also have to replace lost or damaged power banks more often if customers use them more frequently, which adds costs.
Overall, a subscription could make GlowCharge more appealing but might reduce profit if the fee is too low."

**Why L2?**

- AO2 applied (lost/damaged power banks, occasional users)
- Limited analysis
- Weak evaluation
- Judgement shallow

**Band: Level 2 (5–8 marks)**

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# 🟡 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (L3 — AO1 + AO2 + basic AO3)

**Answer (L3 — 262 words)**
"Subscription pricing could help GlowCharge create a more predictable income stream. At the moment the business relies on customers renting a power bank when their phone battery is low, which is unpredictable. A subscription means GlowCharge earns money each month even if the customer doesn't use the service. This could help GlowCharge plan spending on new units and charging stations. Subscriptions may also increase loyalty, reducing the chances of customers switching to competitors at train stations or shopping centres.
However, the subscription model may not work well for GlowCharge unless it understands how often customers use the service. Many people only need a power bank occasionally, such as when travelling or at festivals. If the subscription price is low, these customers might not subscribe, so GlowCharge would not gain much. Heavy users, on the other hand, might subscribe and use the chargers more often, increasing wear and tear. GlowCharge may have to buy more replacement batteries or power banks, raising costs.
Overall, the subscription model could improve GlowCharge's income reliability, but it depends on customer usage patterns and the subscription price."

**Why L3?**

- Decent AO1
- Good AO2 (footfall variation, hardware wear, customer patterns)
- Some analysis and evaluation
- Not fully balanced
- Judgement not deeply justified

**Band: Level 3 (9–10 marks)**

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# 🟢 LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR (L4 — AO1 + AO2 + DEEP AO3, multi-layered evaluation)

**Answer (L4 — 421 words)**
"Switching to a subscription model could significantly improve GlowCharge's financial stability. The current pay-per-use model relies on situational demand such as commuters

forgetting their chargers, festival visitors running low on battery or shoppers staying out longer than planned. These spikes are unpredictable, which makes it difficult for GlowCharge to forecast revenue. A monthly subscription would provide a steady and reliable income stream, improving cash-flow management and helping the business invest in additional charging stations or higher-capacity power banks. Additionally, subscriptions encourage long-term loyalty. If customers subscribe, they are less likely to switch to competing power-bank rental kiosks in transport hubs. This reduces churn and strengthens GlowCharge's brand presence.

However, this model creates several operational and financial risks. Subscriptions incentivise heavier usage; customers who previously rented only in emergencies may now use the service more often, increasing wear and tear. GlowCharge would need to maintain larger stocks of power banks and replace degraded batteries more frequently, raising costs. Moreover, a subscription model may appeal primarily to frequent travellers, leaving occasional users behind. If the subscription fee is priced too low, GlowCharge may lose revenue from people who once paid high one-off fees. Another challenge is misuse: subscribers may forget to return power banks for long periods, which increases losses unless GlowCharge introduces penalties or tracking.

GlowCharge must also consider competitor behaviour. If rival companies continue using pay-per-use pricing, GlowCharge may shift its model too early, particularly if customer demand for subscriptions is low. The business may also need to invest in a new digital system to manage recurring payments, account management and usage tracking, adding setup and maintenance costs.

Overall, the subscription model is beneficial **if** GlowCharge has strong customer data showing a large base of regular users, and if it can manage the increased operational pressure caused by heavier usage. If the business misprices the subscription or lacks the capacity to replace damaged units quickly, the financial risk could outweigh the stable income. The decision ultimately depends on pricing strategy, hardware durability and the reliability of GlowCharge's logistics."

**Why L4?**

- Deep AO1
- Rich AO2 (wear, footfall, misuse, competitor models, logistics)
- Multi-step analysis
- Balanced evaluation
- Fully justified judgement
- Strong conditional reasoning
- Proper length (400–450 words)

**Band: Level 4 (11–12 marks)**

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# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR (Looks polished but is actually L3)

**Answer (Fake-L4 — 271 words)**
"A subscription model might help GlowCharge by making income more predictable. Customers may like paying monthly instead of paying each time they need a charger. This can also help GlowCharge keep customers for longer.
But there are problems. GlowCharge would have to replace more power banks because customers may use them more often. The company might also lose money from people who used to pay high one-off fees. If customers do not use the service enough, they may cancel the subscription.
Overall, I think it is a good idea because many people prefer subscriptions and it gives regular income."

**Why NOT L4?**

- AO2 vague
- No multi-step evaluation
- Large missing consequences
- Judgement unjustified
- Not balanced enough

→ **Capped at Level 3**

# ⭐ 12 MARK EXEMPLAR PACK #3 — SKYVIEW DRONE PHOTOGRAPHY

## Question (12 marks)

**"SkyView Drone Photography is considering offering a premium 'same-day editing and delivery' service for an additional fee.
Evaluate whether this is the best decision for the business."**

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (L1 — AO1 only)

**Answer (L1 — 101 words)**
"Offering same-day editing could help SkyView because customers will get their photos quicker. This might make more people want to use them. But it could also be bad because it will take more time and effort. The business might need more workers and this will cost money. It could be good or bad."

**Why L1?**

- AO1 only
- No AO2 (no drones, editing software, wedding events, weather issues, etc.)
- No analysis
- No evaluation
- No real judgement

**Band: 1–4 marks**

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (L2 — AO1 + simple AO2)

**Answer (L2 — 183 words)**
"Same-day editing and delivery could attract more customers because people often want photos or videos quickly after an event. For example, wedding couples or estate agents might want results on the same day. This could make SkyView seem more professional and allow them to charge extra for the service.
However, editing photos and videos quickly takes time. SkyView may need more staff or longer working hours to meet the deadline. The business may also need better editing software or faster computers, which cost money. If there are a lot of bookings in one day, SkyView might struggle to finish everything on time, leading to complaints.
Overall, offering same-day editing could increase revenue but may also increase costs and pressure."

**Why L2?**

- AO1 and AO2 present

- Limited depth
- Basic evaluation only
- Judgement not justified

**Band: 5–8 marks**

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# 🟡 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (L3 — AO1 + AO2 + basic AO3)

**Answer (L3 — 275 words)**
"Offering a premium same-day editing service could help SkyView attract high-value customers who need quick turnaround. Estate agents, wedding clients and marketing teams often want content uploaded immediately for advertising, and being able to deliver on the same day gives SkyView a competitive advantage. This could allow the business to charge a higher price, increasing revenue per job. Fast delivery may also improve the business's reputation, leading to positive reviews.
However, same-day editing places pressure on staff. Drone photography requires both flying and editing skills, and offering same-day delivery means editors must be available immediately after shoots. This may cause scheduling problems, especially if SkyView has multiple bookings in a day. There is also a risk that staff may rush editing to meet deadlines, leading to lower quality and disappointed customers. SkyView may need better computers, memory cards and backup drives to handle high-volume editing, adding costs.
Overall, same-day editing could give SkyView a competitive advantage but increases pressure and costs."

**Why L3?**

- AO1 and AO2 strong
- Some AO3, but not fully balanced
- Judgement simplistic
- Missing deeper operational, regulatory, and workflow analysis

**Band: 9–10 marks**

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# 🟢 LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR (L4 — AO1 + AO2 + deep AO3, fully balanced)

**Answer (L4 — 423 words)**
"Introducing a premium same-day editing and delivery service could significantly strengthen SkyView's competitive positioning. In industries such as wedding videography, estate-agent marketing and social-media advertising, clients increasingly prioritise speed. If SkyView can deliver edited aerial footage within hours, it may appeal to customers with urgent deadlines. This service allows the business to charge a higher fee, increasing revenue per booking. Because drone jobs often involve travel time and short filming sessions, the added income from same-day editing could improve overall profitability without requiring additional flights. Fast delivery could also enhance SkyView's online reputation, as clients may leave positive reviews, which is crucial in a competitive creative industry.

However, there are substantial operational challenges. Drone shoots already require precise planning, travel, battery management and compliance with safety regulations. Adding same-day editing means staff must immediately edit footage after the job, which may extend working hours and increase fatigue. If the business has multiple bookings in one day, it may be impossible to deliver same-day edits without hiring dedicated editors. This significantly raises labour costs. Additionally, high-quality editing requires powerful computers; upgrading hardware and software increases capital expenditure. There is also a risk that rushing edits reduces quality, weakening SkyView's brand image and causing refunds or poor reviews.

Another consideration is demand uncertainty. Not all clients will want or need same-day delivery. If SkyView invests heavily in faster computers or additional editors but few customers choose the premium service, the costs may not be recovered. Furthermore, poor weather conditions may delay filming, leaving less time for editing and increasing the chance of missed deadlines.

Overall, same-day editing is a strong opportunity **if** SkyView has enough staff, appropriate editing hardware and a clear pricing strategy that covers additional labour and equipment costs. The service is most effective for high-value clients with urgent deadlines. If SkyView cannot guarantee consistent quality or has limited editing capacity, the pressure and financial investment may outweigh the benefits. The decision depends on scheduling, staffing, hardware capability and customer demand."

**Why L4?**

- Deep AO1 (workflow, regulations, hardware, labour)
- Rich AO2 (weddings, estate agents, battery management)
- Multi-step analysis
- Balanced evaluation

- Conditional judgement
- Realistic examiner length (400+ words)

**Band: 11–12 marks**

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# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR (Looks strong but is L3)

**Answer (Fake-L4 — 269 words)**
"A premium same-day editing service could help SkyView attract customers who need quick results. It makes the business stand out and allows them to charge more money. This could increase revenue and help them grow.
However, editing takes time and SkyView might not be able to do it quickly if they have lots of jobs. They may need better computers or more staff, which costs money. If they rush the job, the quality might not be good.
Overall I think it is a good idea because customers always want fast results and it makes SkyView more competitive."

**Why NOT L4?**

- AO2 shallow
- Missing complex reasoning
- Evaluation superficial
- No balanced argument
- Judgement unjustified
  → **Capped at L3**

# ⭐ 12 MARK EXEMPLAR PACK #4 — AQUAPURE HOME WATER SYSTEMS

## Question (12 marks)

**“AquaPure is considering offering interest-free payment plans to customers who purchase its home water-filtration systems.**
**Evaluate whether this is the best decision for the business.”**

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# 🔴 LEVEL 1 EXEMPLAR (L1 — AO1 only)

**Answer (L1 — 103 words)**
“Offering interest-free payments could help AquaPure because customers might like paying in smaller amounts instead of all at once. This could make more people buy the system. But it might also be bad because AquaPure gets the money slowly and customers might stop paying. Then the business loses money. It could be good or bad.”

**Why L1?**

- Pure AO1
- No AO2 (installation, maintenance, reliability, competition)
- No analysis
- No evaluation
- No judgement

**Band: Level 1 (1–4 marks)**

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# 🟠 LEVEL 2 EXEMPLAR (L2 — AO1 + simple AO2)

**Answer (L2 — 184 words)**
“Offering interest-free payments may attract more customers because the filtration systems are expensive. Some families cannot afford the full cost at once, so paying monthly could encourage more people to buy one. This would increase sales for AquaPure.
However, AquaPure would not receive the money straight away. If customers take 12–24 months to pay, the business may run into cash-flow issues, especially when buying equipment or paying staff to install the units. There is also a risk that some customers might miss payments, which could lead to financial loss.
Overall, interest-free plans could increase sales but may cause cash-flow problems.”

**Why L2?**

- AO2 applied (installers, affordability)
- Limited detail
- Basic evaluation
- Judgement simple

**Band: Level 2 (5–8 marks)**

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# 🟡 LEVEL 3 EXEMPLAR (L3 — AO1 + AO2 + basic AO3)

**Answer (L3 — 269 words)**
"Interest-free payment plans could increase AquaPure's customer base because water-filtration systems can be expensive and many households prefer paying in smaller monthly amounts. This could help AquaPure reach customers who would normally choose cheaper options such as supermarket filters. If AquaPure attracts more customers, the business can spread fixed costs like warehouse rent and installation tools over more units, improving profitability.
However, the business must manage the financial risk of delayed payments. AquaPure must pay installers, buy filtration units and maintain vans before receiving the customer's full payment. If many customers choose interest-free plans, cash-flow pressure may increase. There is also a risk of missed payments if customers cancel or change bank details. AquaPure may need to introduce payment-tracking systems or spend time chasing overdue payments.
Overall, interest-free payments could expand AquaPure's market but may create financial risks."

**Why L3?**

- Clear AO1
- Good AO2 (warehouse, installation vans, cheap alternatives)
- Some analysis and evaluation
- Judgement shallow
- Not enough multi-step argument for L4

**Band: Level 3 (9–10 marks)**

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# 🟢 LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR (L4 — deep AO3, fully balanced)

**Answer (L4 — 416 words)**
"Offering interest-free payment plans could significantly increase AquaPure's ability to reach middle-income households who cannot afford the upfront cost of a full water-filtration system. These systems are often priced between £500–£1,200, which is a barrier for many customers. By allowing interest-free monthly payments, AquaPure makes the product more accessible and may dramatically increase sales volume. Higher sales would allow the business to order filtration units in bulk, reducing average cost per unit and improving profit margins. Additionally, interest-free plans may help AquaPure stand out from competitors who require payment upfront, giving the business a clear marketing advantage.

However, offering payment plans creates major financial challenges. AquaPure must pay installers, purchase units and cover travel costs before receiving payment from the customer. This means the business takes on cash-flow risk, particularly if many customers choose long-term payment options. AquaPure may need a strong cash reserve or external financing to maintain operations. There is also default risk; if customers miss payments or cancel direct debits, AquaPure may struggle to recover the outstanding balance. This is more likely in households with unstable income. The business may need administrative staff or software systems to monitor payments, adding to overhead costs.

Another concern is the impact on installation scheduling. If demand rises sharply due to the attractive payment plans, AquaPure may struggle to complete installations quickly. This could lead to delays, negative reviews and pressure on installation teams. Furthermore, offering interest-free plans may attract price-sensitive customers who prioritise low monthly payments over long-term maintenance. If customers cannot afford replacement filters later, AquaPure may earn less repeat revenue.

Overall, interest-free payment plans are beneficial **if** AquaPure has strong cash reserves, reliable payment-processing systems and enough installation capacity to handle increased demand. If these conditions are not met, the financial and operational risks may outweigh the benefits. The decision depends on cash-flow stability, customer reliability and the business's ability to scale."

**Why L4?**

- AO1 accurate
- AO2 rich (pricing, vans, equipment, filter replacements)

- Deep AO3 (cash-flow, demand shock, administrative load)
- Fully balanced
- Conditional judgement
- Multi-layer consequences
- Authentic 400+ word length

**Band: Level 4 (11–12 marks)**

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# ⚠️ FAKE LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR (Looks polished but is L3)

**Answer (Fake-L4 — 281 words)**
"Offering interest-free payments could help AquaPure gain more customers because it makes the filtration system easier to afford. Customers may prefer spreading the cost, and the business could increase sales. It also helps AquaPure compete with other companies.
However, this can also cause problems. AquaPure may not get the money straight away and could have cash-flow issues. Customers might also miss payments, which reduces the business's profit. AquaPure might need to spend money on software or staff to manage payments.
Overall, I think it is a good idea because it increases sales and makes the business more competitive."

**Why NOT L4?**

- AO2 shallow
- No multi-step reasoning
- Weak evaluation
- Judgement unbalanced
- Missing dependency factors

→ **Capped at Level 3**